30th October 2026

SHARK TANK

FR. CONCEICAO RODRIGUES COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

OUR TIME IS NOW
The industry's rising stars speak up



ACM
ASSOCIATION OF COMPUTING MACHINERY

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ABOUT SHARK TANK



Shark Tank is more than an entrepreneurial competition it is a platform where ideas, ambition, business, and opportunity come together on one stage.

Designed as a one-day, national-level entrepreneurial experience, the event brings together aspiring founders, innovators, industry professionals, mentors, investors, and audiences from across India. It gives young entrepreneurs the opportunity to move beyond classrooms and experience what it takes to build, present, defend, and grow a business.

From ideation and validation to strategy, finance, market positioning, scalability, and investment, participants will navigate the realities of entrepreneurship before a distinguished panel of Sharks, where ideas will be challenged and opportunities explored.

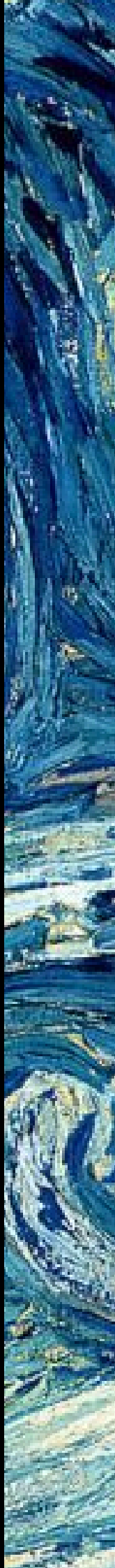
Beyond the venue, Shark Tank will extend its reach through digital promotions, social media storytelling, event coverage, and planned streaming, bringing the entrepreneurial journey to a wider audience. At its heart, Shark Tank is about creating a space where ambition gets a platform, ideas get challenged, and potential gets noticed.

We are building more than an event.

We are building a stage for the next generation of entrepreneurs.

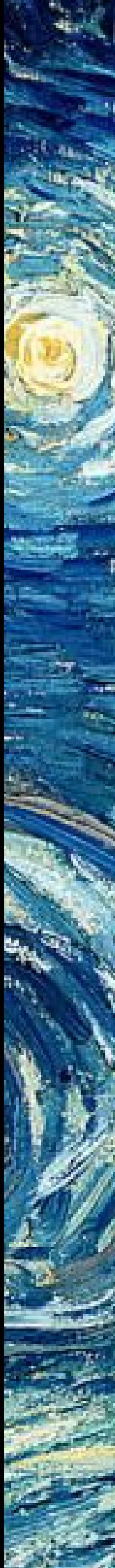
GENERAL *Rules*

- All participants must report 20 minutes before their allotted time. Late reporting may lead to disqualification or reduced pitch time.
- No team is allowed to exceed 4 members.
- Teams must bring valid ID cards and confirmation receipts.
- Plagiarism will lead to immediate disqualification.
- Referencing existing businesses , products or research is allowed only if properly acknowledged and significantly modified to showcase teams own innovation
- Teams will be made to submit presentation materials a day in advance which will then be evaluated by plagiarism detection tools (Quetext)
- Less than 15% similarity will be tolerated, or else we will ask the team to re-evaluate their presentation or face penalties.
- Judges' decisions will be final and binding.
- Any form of misbehavior will result in disqualification.
- Real investments, mentorships, or internships offered by Sharks are separate from the simulated equity game.
- Dress Code: Teams must follow either formal attire or a product themed dress code during their presentation.
- Ensure that the presentation is compatible with the event's technical equipment.
- Teams MUST submit their presentations in advance to avoid last minute delays.



GENERAL *Rules*

- Strict time limits will be enforced, warning bell at 2 minutes remaining,hard cutoff at the end.
- Props or Demos if any must be pre-approved by the organizers to ensure safety and feasibility.
- Teams must remain in the designated waiting area until their turn, no external assistance is allowed once the pitching begins.
- Use of foul language, offensive visuals or sensitive content will not be tolerated and will lead to an instant disqualification.
- Any disputes must be addressed to the organizing committee not directly to the judges.
- Teams must respect confidentiality, sharing or recording of other team's pitches is strictly prohibited.
- Organizers reserve the right to modify schedules if required for smooth conduct of the event.
- Teams are encouraged to maintain professional ethics-defaming other teams or copying ideas will result in penalties or disqualification
- Teams must come prepared with their presentation material in two formats:
  (a) on a laptop capable of screen sharing via HDMI,
  (b) as a PPT file saved on a pendrive, to be submitted on the day of the event



SCHEDULE



SCREENING ROUND

- All registered teams will participate in an online screening round based on their submitted pitch deck.
- Teams must upload their pitch deck directly on Unstop before the specified submission deadline.
- The pitch deck should clearly present the startup/business idea, problem statement, proposed solution, target audience, USP, market opportunity, business model, and scalability.
- The submitted deck will be evaluated by the organizing/judging panel based on the quality, originality, feasibility, and potential of the idea.
- Top 17 teams will be shortlisted for the main event at Fr. CRCE.
- The screening round is deck-based only; no live pitching or negotiation with judges will take place at this stage.

YOUR PITCH DECK SHOULD COVER:

- Problem Statement
- Proposed Solution
- Target Audience
- Innovation / USP
- Market Opportunity
- Business Model
- Competition / Differentiation
- Scalability
- Revenue Potential

NATIONAL-LEVEL FINALS



30th October,2026

Note: All shortlisted teams will step into a **mock investment simulation in one integrated Final Round**, combining the pitch, valuation, investment ask, Q&A, and negotiation.

Time allocated per team : 13 mintues

01

Pitch & Business Presentation : 7 minutes

- Problem and solution
- Target market
- Business model
- Competition
- Revenue model
- Scalability
- Financial projections

02

Q&A & Negotiation/Investment Ask : 6 minutes

- Team declares its startup valuation.
- Team states the investment required.
- Team specifies the equity offered.
- Sharks may question the business model, market, costing and projections.
- Sharks may accept, counter-offer or reject the proposal. Teams must justify their valuation and equity ask.
- Sharks may form joint deals or restructure offers.

03

Final Deal At the end of the team's allotted time:

- Final investment amount is recorded.
- Final equity offered is recorded.
- Any agreed deal terms are locked.
- The team's performance is evaluated using the Day 2 grading criteria.

Valuation & Equity Rules

Valuation

- Proposed startup valuation must fall between ₹2,00,000 and ₹20,00,000 or in special cases, relevant to the idea.
- Teams must be able to justify their valuation using relevant business and financial reasoning.
- Unrealistic valuations may result in deductions under Business Knowledge & Costing.

Equity

- The combined equity held by all Sharks cannot exceed 49% of a team.
- If a team gives away more than 49% total equity, it will receive a loss-of-control penalty.
- Equity may accumulate across negotiations, but the overall 49% cap remains applicable.

Equity Penalty

- Equity Cap (Total): All sharks combined cannot hold more than 49% equity in a single team.
- Dilution Penalty: If a team gives away more than 49% total equity, they will be penalized for “loss of control.”
- Equity Stacking: Equity can accumulate across rounds, but caps and penalties still apply.

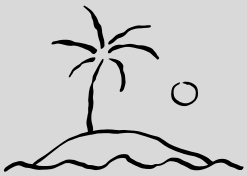
Judging Criteria

- Novelty & Creativity (20%)
- Business Model & Scalability (20%)
- Business Knowledge (15%)
- Sales Projection & Costing (15%)
- Pitch & Communication (15%)
- Negotiation Skill (15%)

Timeline

- 9:00 a.m. - 9:30 a.m. : Opening & Instructions
- 9:45 a.m. - 12:30 p.m. : Commence Shark Tank (10 teams)
- 12:30 p.m. - 1:15 p.m. : Lunch Break!
- 1:15 p.m. - 3:30 p.m. : Final Negotiations (last 10 teams)
- 3:30 p.m. - 3:45 p.m. : Jury Deliberation
- 3:45 p.m. - 4:30 p.m. : Winner Announcement & Closing

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